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DYSTOPIA

AMBIENCE
& DRONE

24BIT
48KHZ

Thanks for downloading **Dystopia
Ambience & Drone** and supporting
independent audio!

Gear used to capture source material

Sennheiser MKH8040 & MKH30 M/S rig,
LOM Usi Pro, LOM Elektrousi, Sound Devices Mix Pre 6

Metadata

BWF & Soundminer (embedded), PDF

Get In Touch

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Getting the most out of **Dystopia Ambience & Drone**

Layer tracks

Layering a few samples together gives you an almost endless supply of dark background ambience. Most ambiences have different lengths and looping points, resulting in a constantly evolving atmosphere with no discernable looping as the layers go in and out of sync with one another.

Filter the audio

Tracks can be filtered with EQ, either in real-time using audio middleware, or offline in an audio editor (though be sure to save as a new file in order to retain the original after processing). If you need a darker, subtler sound, you can filter out high frequencies with a low-pass filter. Or experiment with filtering out the low-end from one track, and the high-end from another and combine the two for even more layering options.

Cut the loops to size

Some loops contain evolving material and are longer than others. If you need to cut the duration of a track down but maintain a seamless loop, follow these steps in your audio editor:

1. Locate the section of the clip you wish to isolate and use as the new, shorter loop and make a selection around it. Trim off any remaining audio.
2. Locate a reasonable starting point for the new loop, somewhere near the middle where there's a bit of a

lull in activity – not part way through a crescendo for example. Your audio editor should have a ‘slice at zero-crossings’ option – use this to cut the file in two. If it doesn’t have such an option, cut it in two, zoom right in and apply a very short fadeout to only the last few samples of the first half, and a very short fade in to the second. This will ensure there are no audible clicks or pops at the loop point.

2. Move the first clip (the first half) to the end of the second half.

3. If your audio editor supports automatic crossfading, drag the second (now rightmost) clip back slightly over the first, making sure to line up peaks and troughs in the waveform as best possible. Experiment with placement and test by playing the loop – when it sounds good, it is!

If your editor doesn’t support automatic crossfading between clips, you can manually apply a crossfade or apply a fade-out to the end of the first clip and a fade-in to the second, making sure the two clips are overlapping and share similar fade-in and -out points.

4. You can now make a selection around the looping region and export it as a new file, ready to use.

Compress the audio on import (Unity)

Chances are you may wish to compress the audio quite a bit to save on valuable space. If this is the case, setting the audio import settings to Vorbis, with a quality from about 40-75 (depending on target platform) will drastically reduce the filesize. Lower values will start to introduce noticeable artifacts so experiment with settings to find what works.

Trigger one-shot effects dynamically

The included one-shot effects work well over the looping ambiences and drones – try triggering them based on in-game events to make the atmosphere feel alive and responsive. For example, maybe a particular sound triggers as you enter a new room within the same area, or as a subtle hint to act after you fulfil a particular condition. Perhaps you sight a monster, alien or dark spirit for the first time in the shadows ahead – triggering an eerie sound at this point might help add to the tension!

Use the samples in your game trailer

Easily create a dark, visceral atmosphere for your trailers by layering Dystopia loops. With liberal use of the included sub-bass drops and one-shots as transition effects, you have a pretty good dark trailer scoring toolkit at your disposal!

Use the samples in your music tracks

Maybe you're a composer for games or other media, or a musician working on a new EP. The ambiences provide a perfect bed for music to sit in, and make for easy material to process into a musical masterpiece.

Use the samples as source for sound design

Grab a chunk of an ambience or two, pitch one down over time, speed one up, throw on some EQ, saturation, and maybe some delay. Before you know it you've got the beginnings of a great spell-casting sound ready to use in your project!

Get in touch!

If you have any questions or feedback, ideas for content or problems that need solving, sound and music libraries you wish existed, or maybe you're feeling sociable and just want to say hi, don't hesitate to get in touch, I'd be happy to hear from you!

Email: **rich@shapeforms.com**

Thanks again for purchasing **Dystopia** – I hope you get as much out of it as I did making it!

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